

Dipankar Srirag

PhD Candidate, UNSW Sydney

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Education

Present Jun 2025	University of New South Wales Ph.D., Computer Science and Engineering • Advisors : Dr. Aditya Joshi, Dr. Padmanesan Narasimhan, Dr. Salil Kanhere. • Funded by the NHMRC Ideas Grant.	Sydney, Australia
Sep 2024 Sep 2022	University of New South Wales M.S., Information Technology, WAM : 81.3. • Advisor : Dr. Aditya Joshi. • Thesis : Training Dialect Adapters for Decoder Models Using Natural Conversations.	Sydney, Australia

Work Experience

May 2025 May 2024	University of New South Wales Researcher/Research Officer • Built the BESSTIE benchmark, a novel dataset spanning sentiment and sarcasm classification across 3 English dialects. This work is funded by Google Research Scholar grant. • Designed and implemented scalable annotation pipelines to collect and validate 12,600 samples from Reddit and Google Places, covering diverse dialects for NLP evaluation. • Evaluated two open-weight LLMs (Gemma, Llama) for dialect robustness using sarcasm explanation generation, with statistically significant improvements using a pragmatic reasoning-based prompting strategy. • Audited GPT-based models for translation of school communication across 22 languages, using performance metrics such as BLEU, chrF, and ROUGE. • Mentored undergraduate students through the UNSW Taste of Research program, guiding them in literature reviews, controlled experimentation, and research writing. • Presented work at the UNSW AI Symposium 2024, showcasing practical contributions of dialect-aware LLM evaluations.	Sydney, Australia
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Teaching Experience

Course Admin, Natural Language Processing	UNSW Sydney	Jan 2026 - Present
• Class Size : 400+ students. • Course Feedback : 97.1% broad agreement.		
Casual Academic, Neural Networks and Deep Learning	UNSW Sydney	May 2024 - Present
• Class Size : 150+ students. • Tutor Feedback : 98.5% broad agreement.		
Casual Academic, Data Structures and Algorithms	UNSW Sydney	Sept 2025 - Present
• Class Size : 150+ students. • Tutor Feedback : 100% broad agreement.		

Publications and Preprints

P=Preprints, C=Conference, W=Workshop

[P.1]	LLMs Anchor on Chief Complaint and Fail to Integrate Evidence in Sequential Clinical Triage. <u>Dipankar Srirag, H Zhao, A Kumar, E Hopper, M Dalton, QD Nguyen, A Joshi, S Kanhere, P Narasimhan.</u> <i>Under review</i>	[PREPRINT]
[C.8]	From Triage to Discharge : A Survey of NLP Tasks, Methods, and Open Challenges in the Emergency Department. <u>Dipankar Srirag, A Joshi, S Kanhere, P Narasimhan.</u> <i>In Proceedings of the 2026 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (To appear).</i>	[EMNLP '26]
[C.7]	DiaLLM : An Investigation into the Robustness-Generation Gap in English Dialect Adaptation. <u>J Painter, Dipankar Srirag, A Kappiyath, D Kanojia, A Joshi, L Yin.</u> <i>In Proceedings of the 2026 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (To appear).</i>	[EMNLP '26]
[C.6]	Scaled Autoregressive Projection Steering (SAPS) : Token-level Steering to Induce Sarcasm and Humblebrag in Text. <u>S Naganna, RS Chowdhury, Dipankar Srirag, A Joshi.</u> <i>Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics : EMNLP 2026 (To appear).</i>	[EMNLP '26]

- [C.5] **Retell, Reward, Repeat : Reinforcement Learning for Narrative Theory-Informed Story Retelling.**
DY Liu, X Muston, Dipankar Srirag, A Joshi, S Sequoiah-Grayson.
Proceedings of the 19th International Natural Language Generation Conference (To appear). [INLG '26]
- [C.4] **TriageSim : A Conversational Emergency Triage Simulation Framework from Structured Electronic Health Records.**
Dipankar Srirag, QD Nguyen, A Joshi, P Narasimhan, S Kanhere.
Proceedings of Interspeech 2026. [INTERSPEECH '26]
- [C.3] **A Taxonomy-Driven Case Study of Australian Web Resources Against Technology-Facilitated Abuse.**
Dipankar Srirag, X Cen, R Masood, A Joshi.
Proceedings of the 31st Australasian Conference on Information Security and Privacy. [ACISP '26]
- [W.3] **Far Out : Evaluating Language Models on Slang in Australian and Indian English.**
DK Dilsiz, Dipankar Srirag, A Joshi.
Proceedings of the 13th Workshop on NLP for Similar Languages, Varieties and Dialects, EACL 2026. [VARDIAL '26]
- [W.2] **Nek Minit : Harnessing Pragmatic Metacognitive Prompting for Explainable Sarcasm Detection of Australian and Indian English.** 🏆
Dipankar Srirag*, I Singh*, A Joshi.
Proceedings of the 23rd Annual Workshop of the Australasian Language Technology Association. [ALTA '25]
- [C.2] **BESSTIE : A Benchmark for Sentiment and Sarcasm Classification for Varieties of English.**
Dipankar Srirag, A Joshi, J Painter, D Kanojia.
Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics : ACL 2025. [ACL '25]
- [C.1] **Predicting the Target Word of Game-playing Conversations using a Low-Rank Dialect Adapter for Decoder Models.**
Dipankar Srirag, A Joshi, J Eisenstein.
2025 Conference of the Nations of the Americas Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics. [NAACL '25]
- [W.1] **Evaluating Dialect Robustness of Language Models via Conversation Understanding.**
Dipankar Srirag, NR Sahoo, A Joshi.
Second Workshop on Scaling Up Multilingual & Multi-Cultural Evaluation, COLING 2025. [SUMEVAL '25]

Awards and Achievements

- **Google Travel Award** : Unrestricted travel grant valued at **AUD 2500**.
- **UNSW TFS Scholarship** : Full tuition fee waiver with annual stipend of **AUD 40000**.
- **UNSW Award of Excellence** : Recognised for academic distinction during master's program.

Academic Service

- **Program Committee Member** : C3NLP Workshop 2025, Queer in AI Workshop 2025.
- **Peer Reviewer** : NeurIPS 2026, ACL Rolling Review (ARR), The Web Conference (WWW) 2025.

References

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